

9 Using commands

9.1 Navigating in Unix

If you cannot see any icons for your files and folders, how are you supposed to work with them? You can ask Unix to tell you what folder you're in presently (using the `pwd` command), what's inside it (using the `ls` command), and what folder you want to switch to (using the `cd` command).

Note

UNIX is case sensitive. Command names are almost always in lowercase (like `ls` and `pwd`).

9.1.1 `pwd` (print working directory)

This is one of the most basic navigation commands. The `pwd` command doesn't actually print anything on your printer as the name suggests; instead, the `pwd` command types out, on the screen, the path Unix thinks you're in (the working directory).

9.1.2 `ls` (list)

The `ls` command makes terminal list out the names of all the files and folders in the folder you're in, i.e., your working directory.

Terminal can also list what's in any other directory (one that's not the working directory) just by adding its pathname as an argument.

To see a list of the files in your Documents directory, then, you could just type `ls /Users/Anot/Documents`. Better yet, you could save typing with `ls ~/Documents` because the `~` symbol is short for my home directory. Some useful flags for the `ls` command are:

-a. The `ls` command will even display the names of files and folders that are invisible by the finder's definition. That doesn't mean you will find everything. Files that are invisible by the Unix definition of invisibility still don't show up. `-R` produces a recursive listing. You will even get the list of sub directories in the list.

9.1.3 `cd` (change directory)

To change your working directory, you use the `cd` command, followed by the path of the directory you



List of files in your working directory